

1. Summary of the Meeting

What Was Discussed

Topic	Details
Prototype Direction	Satyam proposed an extension → mobile app that scans content and compares against a "masculinity dictionary"
User Experience Concern	Satyam rightly asked: <i>"Why will a user want to know if he is watching correct content or not?"</i>
Data Collection Problem	How to scan Instagram Reels/YouTube without user manually pasting links?
Platform Restrictions	Chrome extensions don't work on mobile; screen recording = privacy nightmare
Final Decision	Advisor: Go with a simple analysis dashboard (website-based)
Timeline	Satyam estimates 3-4 days for a basic prototype skeleton
Patent Consideration	Advisor mentioned patent potential; VIT would own it, students would be inventors

Dictionary Development

Needs collaboration with literature review team

2. Key Issues Identified

Issue 1: Platform Restrictions (Mobile vs. Browser)

Platform	Extension Feasibility	Status
Desktop Browser (Chrome)	✓ Possible	Can build Chrome extension
Mobile Browser (Chrome)	✗ Not possible	Chrome doesn't allow extensions on mobile
Mobile App	⚠ Difficult	Requires app store approval; complex

Advisor's Decision: Go with website/analysis dashboard first. This is safer, faster, and avoids platform restrictions.

Issue 2: How to Collect Data Without Scraping/Interference

Satyam's Concern: *"How will we scan the Instagram Reels that a user is watching?"*

Problem: Instagram doesn't provide an API for real-time reel analysis. Screen recording is a privacy nightmare.

Solution (Implicit in Meeting): Use YouTube Data API v3 instead. YouTube comments are publicly accessible and can be analyzed without platform interference.

Issue 3: User Adoption

Satyam's Question: *"Why will a user want to know if he is watching a correct thing or not?"*

This is a critical question. The tool needs a clear value proposition.

Possible Answers:

- Digital wellbeing: "Understand your social media consumption patterns"
- Parental control: "Monitor content your child is watching"
- Self-reflection: "See how much of your feed reinforces certain norms"
- Research tool: "Analyze comment sections for academic purposes" (most viable)

3. My Recommendations

Recommendation 1: Clarify the Tool's Purpose

The team needs a clear, singular use case. Right now, they're trying to be everything to everyone.

Option	Pros	Cons	Recommendation
YouTube Comment Analyzer	Uses official API; no platform interference; easy to build	Doesn't analyze "what users watch" (only comments)	✅ Best first step
Browser Extension (Desktop)	Tracks user's actual feed	Limited to desktop; user adoption low	⚠️ Good for later

Mobile App	Tracks real-time usage	Complex; requires app store; privacy concerns	❌ Too ambitious
Analysis Dashboard (Website)	Simple; accessible; scalable	Requires user to paste links	✅ Advisor's choice

My recommendation: Start with a YouTube Comment Analysis Dashboard. It's exactly what the advisor suggested, it uses official APIs, and it's demonstrable.

Recommendation 2: Adopt a Two-Phase Approach

Phase	What to Build	Timeline	Goal
Phase 1	Simple YouTube comment analyzer (website)	2-3 weeks	Working prototype for advisor review
Phase 2	Add "masculinity dictionary" + sentiment analysis	2-3 weeks	Enhanced analysis with categories

Recommendation 3: Collaboration with Literature Review Team

Satyam mentioned: *"The research paper will help us come up with some of our own meanings and some of our own definitions."*

✅ This is exactly right. The literature review team should provide:

Deliverable	Timeline	Responsible
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Masculinity keywords dictionary (terms, hashtags)	2 weeks	LR
Category definitions (e.g., appearance, stoicism, dominance)	2 weeks	LR
Validation of dictionary by subject expert	2 weeks	All

Recommendation 4: Address the "Why Would a User Use This?" Question

The tool needs a clear value proposition. Here are some options the team can consider:

Use Case	Description	Feasibility
Academic Research Tool	Researchers can analyze YouTube comments for masculinity themes	✓ Most viable
Content Creator Analytics	Creators can see how their audience reacts to content	✓ Viable
Personal Digital Wellbeing	Users can reflect on their consumption patterns	⚠ Requires user tracking (harder)
Parental Control	Parents can monitor children's content	⚠ Ethical concerns

My recommendation: Frame it as an academic research tool or content creator analytics dashboard. Both have clear users and avoid privacy concerns.

4. Technical Architecture Suggestions

Phase 1 Prototype (Simple Dashboard)

Component	Tool/Technology	Why
Frontend	Streamlit (Python) or HTML/CSS/JS	Fast to build; no frontend expertise needed
Backend	Python Flask	Lightweight; easy API integration
YouTube Data	YouTube Data API v3	Official; free; no legal issues
Sentiment Analysis	MeaningCloud API (free tier)	Advisor specifically recommended this
Hosting	Hugging Face Spaces or Render.com	Free; easy to share with advisor

Phase 2 Enhanced Prototype

Component	Tool/Technology	Why
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NLP/Text Analysis	NLTK or spaCy (Python)	For keyword matching and categorization
Data Storage	Pandas/CSV	Simple; no database setup needed
Visualization	Plotly/Matplotlib	For charts and dashboards
Deployment	Same as Phase 1	No changes needed

What to Avoid

Idea	Why to Avoid
Screen recording	Privacy nightmare; ethics red flag
Instagram real-time scanning	No API available; platform restrictions
Mobile app (first version)	Complex; takes too long
Custom NLP model training	Time sink; not enough labeled data
User tracking over time	Creepy; low adoption; consent issues

5. Suggested Next Steps

Immediate Actions (Next 2-3 Days)

Task	Responsible	Deadline
Create shared document for meeting notes/decisions	-	Today
Share notes with Shlok, Adish	-	Today
Confirm final tool direction with advisor	-	Next meeting
Define masculinity categories (collaborate with LR Team)	Lit Review Team	1 week

Short-Term Actions (Next 2 Weeks)

Task	Responsible	Deadline
Develop masculinity keyword dictionary	Lit Review team	2 weeks
Set up YouTube Data API access	-	1 week
Build basic comment fetcher script	-	1 week
Integrate MeaningCloud sentiment analysis	-	2 weeks
Build simple Streamlit dashboard	-	2 weeks

Meeting/Timeline

Milestone	Date (Approx.)	Deliverable
Skeleton prototype	3-4 days	Basic website framework
Phase 1 complete	2-3 weeks	Working YouTube comment analyzer
Phase 2 complete	4-6 weeks	Dashboard with masculinity categorization
Review with advisor	6-8 weeks	Full demo + documentation

6. Key Takeaways for the Team

Takeaway	Explanation
Start simple	Don't try to build a mobile app or extension first. Build a website dashboard.
Use official APIs	YouTube Data API is safe. No scraping, no platform interference.
Collaborate with literature team	The masculinity dictionary needs to come from research, not random guesses.
Clear user value	Know who will use this and why. Academic research tool is the safest bet.

Patent is a long-term goal

Don't worry about it now. Build something working first.

3-4 days for skeleton is realistic

Satyam's estimate is good. Then iterate.
